

In the Garden God Made

Unit 1 · Pillar 1: Design · Foundations — Senses & Skin

And God said, See, I have given you every herb that yields seed.

- Genesis 1:29

WEEK AT A GLANCE

- MONDAY** Scripture read-aloud (Gen 1:29) God gives every seed-bearing plant as food. Discussion ties to Story 1 + scripture.
- TUESDAY** Chamomile discovery — identify, smell, observe the plant.
- WEDNESDAY** Brew chamomile tea — water, steep, taste, and journal.
- THURSDAY** Chamomile in ancient Egypt — draw in sketchbook.
- FRIDAY** Plant chamomile seeds. Sing chamomile chant for first time.

Subjects woven this week: Science · Health ·
Art · History · Language Arts · Movement

AROUND THE TABLE

*What does your body do when
you're nervous?*

KITCHEN LAB - SUPPLIES NEEDED

- Dried chamomile flowers
- Raw honey
- Kettle
- Mug or cup
- Botanical sketchbook
- Journal & pen



Chamomile

Matricaria chamomilla

Read-Aloud & Discussion

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STORY ORIENTATION

Today is a scripture-reading Monday — the first of about 30 across the year. Read Genesis 1:29 aloud — the verse where God gives every seed-bearing plant as food. This is the theological floor under every herb we'll meet. Discussion can return to Story 1 (Lavender) from last week + bring in the chamomile on the table today.

KEY CONCEPT

Chamomile gently calms the nervous and digestive systems. The body knows how to soothe itself — God designed it that way.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. What happens to your skin when you get a small cut?
2. When you feel scared or nervous, what helps you feel calm?
3. What did God make plants for? Can plants help us heal?

BEAR MOMENT

Bear tries to drink the chamomile tea before it's ready. Patience, Bear — herbs need time to STEEP. That means to sit in hot water and share their flavor.

CHAMOMILE CHANT

*Chamomile, sweet and bright,
Calms the tummy, calms the night —
Daisy of the meadow tea,
Gentle as you'd want to be.*

Today's threads: Language Arts • Science • Health • Art

TEACHER NOTES

TEACHER NOTES:

★ MONDAY - Two kinds of Mondays this year: STORY-LAUNCH Mondays (6 total, one per story) + SCRIPTURE-READING Mondays (30 total). Today: Gen 1:29. Read aloud twice. Ask: 'What did God give us, and what is it for?' Let the child answer in their own words before you add anything. The chamomile on the table today IS the answer to the verse.

TODAY'S WORD: SKIN — outer covering of the body, with three layers God designed to protect and heal.

Discovery

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DISCOVERY LESSON

Today we discover chamomile. Show your child the dried flowers. Smell them together — what do they remind you of? Notice the daisy-shaped head with the yellow center and white petals. This is how botanists identify chamomile: by shape, smell, and color. God made it small but mighty.

CORE QUESTION:

Why do you think God made plants we can smell and taste?

TEACHING PROGRESSION

1. Place dried chamomile flowers in your child's hand.
2. Have them smell, look closely, and describe what they notice.
3. Explain: chamomile is a "nervine" — it helps the body feel calm.
4. Together, look up where chamomile grows in your area.

BEAR MOMENT

Bear sniffs the chamomile and sneezes — a PETAL flew up his nose! How many petals can you count on one flower?

CHAMOMILE CHANT

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Today's threads: Science • Language Arts • Health • Art

TEACHER NOTES

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TODAY'S WORD:

NERVINE — a plant that helps calm the body.

Tuesday is wonder day. Stay curious with them. If they ask a question you can't answer, write it on a line above and explore together.

Kitchen Lab

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KITCHEN LAB

Today we brew chamomile tea together. Pour hot water over the dried flowers and watch the water slowly turn pale gold. This is called an infusion — one of the oldest ways humans have used plants. Notice the calming smell rising in the steam. Sip slowly and notice how your body feels.

TEACHING NOTE

Hot water is hot. Children can measure the dry chamomile and pour cool water. An adult always pours the boiling water. Cover the cup while steeping — the steam carries chamomile's gift.

STEP-BY-STEP

1. Measure 1 teaspoon dried chamomile per cup.
2. Adult pours boiling water (8 oz) over the chamomile.
3. Cover and steep 5 minutes.
4. Strain into a mug.
5. Add a touch of honey. Sip slowly and notice how it feels.

BEAR MOMENT

Bear stares at the steam rising from the chamomile INFUSION — that's the special word for tea made by steeping plants in hot water.

CHAMOMILE CHANT

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TEACHER NOTES

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TODAY'S WORD:

INFUSION — tea made by steeping plants in hot water.

Wednesday is hands-on day. Let your child measure, pour cool water, stir. The doing is the teaching. Hot water stays with you.

History & Art

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HISTORY LESSON

Today we step back in time. Chamomile is one of the oldest healing plants on earth. Ancient Egyptians grew it in their gardens 3,500 years ago and used it to soothe stomachs and calm sleep. They called it the plant of the sun. Greeks and Romans loved it too. Even today, chamomile grows wild in fields all over the world — a gentle, golden gift God planted long before we knew its name.

CREATION CARE TIMELINE

Around 1500 BC, Egyptian healers grew chamomile in temple gardens. They called it the plant of the sun for its yellow center. Add Egyptian healers and chamomile to your Creation Care Timeline poster — your first entry!

ART ACTIVITY

1. Look closely at a real chamomile flower or a dried one.
2. Notice the yellow center and white petals around it.
3. Draw the flower with petals like rays of sun around the middle.
4. Add the stem and the feathery leaves.
5. Color it: yellow for the center, white or pale yellow for the petals.

BEAR MOMENT

Bear adds his paw print to the drawing. The ancient EGYPTIANS pressed plants into clay tablets just like that — a paw print is its own little stamp.

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TEACHER NOTES

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TODAY'S WORD:
HEALER — someone who uses plants and wisdom to help the body mend.

Thursday is connection day. Help your child see the long ribbon of people who have grown and loved chamomile across thousands of years. We're part of that ribbon now.

Garden & Review

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GARDEN ACTIVITY

Today we plant chamomile seeds together. Find a sunny corner of your garden or a small pot of soil. Scatter the tiny seeds — they're so small that just a pinch is enough. Press them gently into the soil. Water lightly. Now we wait. Chamomile sprouts in 7–14 days. While you wait, sing the chamomile chant each morning when you water.

NEXT WEEK

Next week: lemon balm — sweet lemony cousin of lavender. We make honegar (a honey-and-vinegar tonic) and open Monday with scripture.

WEEK REVIEW

1. Look at your chamomile drawing above. Describe the flower in your own words.
2. What does chamomile help our bodies do?
3. Why did the Egyptians plant chamomile in their temple gardens?
4. Use the word NERVINE in a sentence about chamomile.

BEAR MOMENT

Bear digs holes in all the wrong places. Good thing chamomile is HARDY — it can sprout even when planted by a clumsy pup.

CHAMOMILE CHANT

*Chamomile, sweet and bright,
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Vovó says: Where chamomile grows, peace is not far behind.

TEACHER NOTES

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TODAY'S WORD:

HARDY — a plant strong enough to survive in tough conditions.

Friday is the gathering day. Sit together around what you've grown and learned. Let the chant echo. Let the silence after the chant matter too.